

3.3.1 CCleaner

CCleaner (www.ccleaner.com) is a freeware system optimisation tool with an inbuilt Registry cleaner. It is light and fast, and can run through your Registry in minutes. It has a clean, user-friendly interface with a one-click operation to start the Registry scan. It takes a conservative approach to cleaning, and the errors discovered are listed for manual review. The problems discovered are classified under various heads such as Unused File Extension, Obsolete Software Key, Missing Shortcut Reference, and other issues. You can choose to skip fixing (or deleting) any of the entries that you feel are valid. Before fixing the Registry, CCleaner also prompts you to save a backup of the Registry prior to cleaning.

3.3.2 Easy Cleaner

Available from <http://personal.inet.fi/business/toniarts/ecleaner.htm>, Easy Cleaner is another free and fast system cleaner that includes Registry cleaning. Like CCleaner, it takes a conservative approach to cleaning the Registry. The start-up screen gives you various cleaning options for different aspects of the system, including the Registry. Again, a single-click on the Find button starts the scan process. The results listed are a bit cryptic: Easy Cleaner doesn't attempt to classify the problems. This may be a bit confusing for the novice, though it does use green and red indicators against the entries that are safe (green) to delete and those (red) that are not. It is more aggressive than CCleaner, but it is usually safe to delete all the entries Easy Cleaner picks out. Nevertheless, it is advisable to review the results before deleting.

3.3.3 jv16 Power Tools

This is another collection of system optimisation tools that includes Registry cleaning. The latest version—jv16 Power Tools 2006, available from www.jv16.org—is a fully-functional 30-day trial product that must be purchased if you wish to use it beyond the trial period. They also have an older freeware version which is still available for download “in the wild.” Run a Google search for “jv16 Power Tools 1.3.0.195” to find download sites for this product version.